

ACL 

vs.

Data Policy 

General knowledge



What are Data Policies?

Data policies **ensure** your data meets business **requirements**, no matter how it **enters** the system. Think of them as your **data quality guardians**.

Key points

- **Controls** field behavior (mandatory/read-only states)
- **Enforces** rules across all data entry points
- Complements **UI form** policies
- **Ensures** data quality standards

What are Access Control Lists?

ACLs are your security gatekeepers, controlling **who** can do **what** with your ServiceNow **data** and **functions**.

Key points

- Controls **who** can access **what**
- Manages permissions by **role**
- **Secures** UI and API access
- Enforces **security** rules



Core Differences ⚡

Data Policy

Focus on DATA QUALITY



Control HOW data is entered



Applies to all data entry points (UI/imports/APIs)



ACL

Focus on SECURITY



Control WHO has access



Controls basic operations (create/read/write/delete)



Data Policy

Examples

Making "Short Description" field mandatory when creating a new incident

Preventing changes to "Priority" field after incident is closed

Making "Resolution Notes" mandatory when an incident state changes to "Resolved"

ACL Examples

Allowing **only** IT managers to
view salary fields in **HR** records

Restricting incident **deletion** to
admin role

Limiting access to **sensitive**
customer data **based** on user
location

Required Roles

Data Policies

- Admin role required to edit
- No elevation needed

ACLs

- Security_admin role required to edit
- Admin role can only view and debug
- Requires role elevation





Thank you!

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